VIT Bhopal University

CSE0001 – Digital Literacy

Digital Literacy

Portfolio Project Report

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Student Digital Ambassador – Digital Literacy Portfolio

Project Overview & Scenario The Student Digital Ambassador program is designed to bridge the gap between academic learning and professional digital readiness. The scenario involves acting as a digital leader within the university community to promote ethical communication, technical proficiency, and cybersecurity awareness. This project serves as a comprehensive portfolio that documents the creation of a professional identity, the mastery of collaboration tools, and the development of strategies to combat prevalent digital threats like UPI fraud. By completing these tasks, I have established a secure and professional digital presence suitable for a future career in AI/ML and software engineering.

Task 1: Digital Literacy Awareness (Infographic)

For the first module, I created a professional infographic using **Canva** to break down the basics of staying safe and professional online. The biggest challenge I faced wasn't the information itself, but actually using the Canva tools to make something that looked "minimalistic." It was surprisingly hard to build the infographic from scratch and elements to find a style that wasn't too clumsy. I wanted to make sure the message was clear at a first glance, so I decided to use vibrant colors to grab attention while keeping the text very concise and short. I didn’t want to overwhelm anyone with a wall of text, so I narrowed the entire infographic down to just three main points that I think every student needs to know.

The first point I focused on was a simple definition of what digital literacy actually is, it's more than just using a computer; it's about being smart with information. Second, I added a section on email etiquette, because knowing how to talk to professors or recruiters is a skill we use every single day. Finally, I included a part on safe internet practices to remind my peers about basic security. By forcing myself to stay minimal, I learned how to prioritize the most important information. Even though it took some time to get the layout right, the final result is a clean, bright guide that conveys a big message without being messy. This task really helped me understand how to communicate clearly in a digital format, which is a huge part of being a Student Digital Ambassador.

Task 2: Digital Portfolio Building

This module was about setting up profiles on GitHub, LinkedIn, Kaggle, and ResearchGate. I had used some of these before, so it wasn't starting from scratch, but I still had to sit down and actually make them look presentable rather than just having accounts that exist.

GitHub was mostly about organizing things properly. I restructured my repositories into folders so everything is easy to navigate. It's a small thing but it makes a difference when someone actually goes through your profile.

Kaggle and ResearchGate felt more relevant to what I actually want to do. Since I'm interested in AI and ML, these are the kind of platforms where the work that matters in that field is competitions, papers, datasets. Having a presence there feels more meaningful than just listing skills on a resume.

The bigger realization from this module was that these profiles are basically your first impression before you even talk to anyone. A recruiter or someone you reach out to will almost always look you up first. So it's worth putting in the effort to make sure what they find actually represents you well, not just a half-filled profile you made two years ago and forgot about.

Task 3: Coding & Collaboration Platforms

This module had two parts 1) practicing Python on HackerRank and 2) building a small data pipeline using Google Forms and Sheets.

The HackerRank part was straightforward. I solved some Python problems, mostly basic ones, just to make sure I actually understand the fundamentals before jumping into anything more complicated. I want to get into AI/ML eventually, and Python is pretty much non-negotiable for that, so I'd rather spend time getting the basics right now than struggle later. Some problems took longer than expected but that's kind of the point.

The second part was more interesting. I made a digital literacy quiz on Google Forms and connected it to a Google Sheet so responses would get recorded automatically. I've used Forms before for random stuff but never really thought about it as a data collection tool. Seeing everything populate in the sheet in real time without having to do anything manually was genuinely satisfying. It's a simple setup but it showed me how much you can do without writing a single line of code.

Task 4: Professional Communication & Etiquette

This module was about communication , specifically learning how to write professional emails and thinking more carefully about how we present ourselves online.

I drafted two emails. One was requesting an extension from a professor and the other was reaching out about a summer internship. Writing them was harder than I expected. It's not just about being polite, it's about not sounding overly formal to the point where it feels copy-pasted, but also not being too casual. Getting that tone right took a few rewrites. I also paid attention to things like subject lines, which I used to ignore, but a vague subject line is probably the easiest way to get your email overlooked.

The second part was making a social media do's and don'ts checklist for college students. This came from something I genuinely think about a lot of us treat personal accounts like they're completely separate from our professional lives, but they're really not. A public post, an old comment, something you were tagged in, it's all findable. So I put together tips around privacy settings and just being more conscious about what goes online.

Task 5: Cybercrime Awareness

For the last module, I looked into UPI and financial fraud, specifically the kind that targets college students in India.

I started by researching a real case where a student got scammed through a "Request Money" trick on a UPI app. The way it works is embarrassingly simple, someone sends you a payment request, and if you're not paying attention, you enter your PIN thinking you're accepting money, but you're actually sending it. That's it. No hacking, no complicated setup. Just confusion and urgency. What got me was that this isn't happening to people who don't know how to use their phones. It's happening to people who use PhonePe and Google Pay every single day.

From that research I made an 8-point checklist covering the basic things people should actually be doing, not sharing PINs, checking links before clicking, that kind of stuff. I also included the National Cyber Crime Helpline number which is 1930, and the reporting portal cybercrime.gov.in. One thing I didn't know before this module was that there's a "Golden Hour" after a fraud happens where if you report it fast enough, there's a chance of recovering the money. That felt like genuinely useful information that most people around me have no idea about.

Out of all the modules this one felt the most relatable. It's not abstract digital literacy, it's something that could realistically happen to my roommate or my parents. That made it easier to care about and easier to explain to others.

Conclusion:

Before starting this project, I thought digital literacy basically just meant knowing how to use apps and get around online. After going through all these modules, that definition feels pretty incomplete now.

It's a lot more than that. It's knowing that what you post at 18 can show up in a job search at 22. It's being able to read something online and actually question whether it's true before sharing it. It's understanding that a UPI scam doesn't require a hacker , just a moment of carelessness. None of this felt obvious to me before, and I'd consider myself reasonably tech-savvy.

Going through each module back to back also made me realize how connected all of it is. The professional profiles, the email writing, the cybercrime awareness , it's all part of the same idea of being intentional about how you exist online. I think that's what being a Digital Ambassador actually means. Not just knowing this stuff yourself but being the person in your friend group or family who can explain it simply when it matters.

It did make me more aware, and honestly a little more careful. I check UPI requests twice now. I think before I post. I actually have a LinkedIn that doesn't look abandoned. Small things, but they add up.

That's probably the most realistic takeaway, not that I'm now some expert, but that I'm paying more attention than I was before.

References

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- GitHub — Where the World Builds Software. Github
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- Google Forms — Free Online Form Builder. forms.google
- National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal, Government of India. cybercrime.gov.in
- National Payments Corporation of India — UPI Safety Guidelines. npci.org.in
- Cyber Crime Helpline — 1930 (24x7 toll-free, Government of India)